

Jidi Cao

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Research interests: Corporate finance, Corporate governance, Sustainability

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EDUCATION

Sept 2022 – Jun 2026	Sichuan University #11 in 2022 Best Chinese Universities Ranking by <i>Shanghai Ranking</i> PhD in Corporate Finance
Sept 2023 – Sept 2024	Technical University of Munich #22 in QS World University Rankings 2026 Visiting PhD Candidate in Finance ↔ Host: Prof. Sebastian Müller, CFA
Sept 2019 – May 2020	EDHEC Business School #7 in the European Business School Rankings 2022 by <i>Financial Times</i> MSc in International Accounting and Finance
Sept 2015 – Jun 2019	Sichuan Agricultural University Bachelor in Financial Accounting

WORKING PAPERS & PROJECTS

1. Silencing the Green Engine: How Shareholder Voice Suppresses Innovation. (*Job Market Paper*) [\[Link\]](#)

Advisor: Haiyue Liu

Using a large language model approach to classify environmental shareholder proposals, we find that proposals advancing to a public vote significantly suppress green innovation. Evidence from media coverage and executive compensation is consistent with a multitasking mechanism in which activism increases short-term reputational pressures while weakening incentives for long-horizon investment. However, environmental activism successfully promotes innovation for firms with ex ante environmental deficiencies and during periods of acute climate sentiment. Our findings highlight an unintended friction of public ESG engagement in the absence of informed target selection and timing.

2. Words of (No-)Action: Regulatory Discretion and Shareholder Voice (*Work in Progress*)

With Christian Breitung and Sebastian Müller

We examine how SEC regulatory screening under Rule 14a-8 shapes shareholder voice and corporate democracy. Utilizing a novel text-based dataset of over 5,300 SEC no-action letters, we introduce a two-stage methodological framework combining a Proposal-Isolated Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) architecture with machine learning to process unstructured information within multi-party governance disputes. This framework enables us to trace the life cycle of management-contested proposals and to identify a selection problem in how disputes are resolved. We examine the economic trade-offs underlying the SEC's allocation of review effort under capacity constraints, and aim to provide evidence on the cost of regulatory screening for shareholder voice, with implications for the ongoing policy debate over Rule 14a-8.

REFERENCES

Vinod Singhal

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Georgia Institute of Technology
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Haiyue Liu

Advisor

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CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

2026 Workshop on Corporate Governance in the Era of Climate Change (Guest speaker: Roni Michaely, HKU), Sichuan University, *Co-organizer* (Est. 2026, Chengdu, China)

2024 Swedish House of Finance and the European Corporate Governance Institute (ECGI) SHoF's Annual Conference on Corporate Governance, *Participant* (August 27–28, Stockholm, Sweden)

2024 The 2nd European Sustainable Finance PhD Workshop, *Participant* (June 18–29, Augsburg, Germany)

2024 ESG Risk Management Framework for the Financial Sector by SUERF, *Participant* (May 29, Vienna, Austria)

2023 Workshop on Current Research Trends in Sustainable Finance by TUM School of Management, *Poster presenter* (November 16–17, Heilbronn, Germany)

OTHER PAPERS & PRE-PHD PUBLICATIONS

1. Liu, H., Wang, Y., & **Cao, J.** (2025). Green credit policy and investment-financing maturity mismatch: evidence from China's green companies. *Environment, Development and Sustainability*, 1–24. (SCIE Q2, IF 4.2)
2. **Cao, J.**, Wang, Y., & Liu, H. (2024). Stock market reaction to new energy vehicle industry development plan: an event study in China. *Climate Policy*, 1–15. (SSCI Q1, IF 6.5)
3. Yang, X., Zou, A., **Cao, J.**, Lai, Y., & Zhang, J. (2023). Systemic risk prediction based on Savitzky-Golay smoothing and temporal convolutional networks. *Electronic Research Archive*, 31(5), 2667–2688. (SCIE Q1)
4. Yang, X., **Cao, J.**, Liu, Z., & Lai, Y. (2022). Environmental policy uncertainty and green innovation: A TVP-VAR-SV model approach. *Quantitative Finance and Economics*, 6(4), 604–621. (ESCI-indexed)
5. **Cao, J.**, Chen, X., Qiu, R., & Hou, S. (2021). Electric vehicle industry sustainable development with a stakeholder engagement system. *Technology in Society*, 67, 101771. (ABS2*, SSCI Q1, IF 10.1)

GRANTS & AWARDS

2023-24 State Scholarship Fund by China Scholarship Council (CSC) of Ministry of Education of the P.R. China (2023–2024)
2022-26 Doctoral student scholarship of Sichuan University

TEACHING

Sept 2024 – Jan 2025	Teaching Assistant Class: <i>Software Design Basic and Python Programming</i> Bachelor program of Business Administration at the Business School of Sichuan University
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OTHER EXPERIENCE

Aug 2020 – Feb 2021	Financial Analyst Finance and Payment Department, PingPong Europe S.A., Luxembourg • Initiated wire transfer, managed virtual accounts, and facilitated automation payment projects • Prepared PI/EMI legal reporting to Commission de Surveillance du Secteur Financier • Collaborated with compliance team in KYC and AML using Moody's RDC screening
Aug–Oct 2017	Field Researcher Governmental Field Survey, Aba Prefecture of China • On-site field surveys and independent evaluation of China's Targeted Poverty Alleviation Policy in underdeveloped areas

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Languages: English (Proficient), French (Basic), Mandarin Chinese (Native)
Certificates: Bloomberg Market Concepts, Certificate of Junior Accountant (Chinese)
Technical Skills: LLM fine-tuning, Text analysis, Web scraping, NLP, RAG
Databases: SEC EDGAR/Form 13F/No-action letter, ISS Shareholder Proposal/ECA, Refinitiv, Compustat, CRSP, FactSet Ownership, BoardEX, RepRisk
Programming: Stata, Python, L^AT_EX